

Colonialism and the Countryside

The Permanent Settlement System

- **Introduced:** Lord Cornwallis in 1793, also known as the Zamindari system.
- **Hierarchy:** Company → Zamindars → Ryots.
- **Features:**
 - Permanent ownership of land given to Zamindars.
 - Fixed revenue demand from Zamindars to the Company.
 - Failure to pay by due date led to confiscation and auction of zamindari.
- **Why Needed?**
 - Increase agricultural output in Bengal.
 - Check recurring famines.
 - Encourage investment in agriculture.
- **Merits:** Fixed and consistent revenue, surplus for Zamindars.
- **Demerits:** High demand, invariable demand, careless Zamindars.

Failure of Zamindars

- **High Demand:** Revenue demand set very high by the Company to avoid future losses due to price rises.
- **Powerless Zamindars:**
 - Troops and Cutcherry (courts) of Zamindars were banned.
 - Ryots (peasants) deliberately delayed payment under the influence of Jotedars.
- **Rigid Demand:** Tax levied invariably for both fertile and barren land.
- **Low Prices:** Agricultural product prices were very low from the 1790s, making payment difficult.
- **Rise of Jotedars:** Rich ryots who lent money to small ryots and held influence over peasants.

Resistance by Zamindars

- **Fictitious Sale:** Transferred property to women (mother, wife, relative) as Company could not confiscate land held by women.
- **Subsequent Auctions:** Zamindar's servants purchased land in auctions and deliberately failed to pay, leading to repeated auctions.
- **By Force:** Lathiyals (enforcers) threatened new landowners to vacate.
- **By Loyalty:** Used villagers' loyalty to resist new landowners.

The Fifth Report

- **Why Needed?** Regulations by the British Parliament led to a committee publishing a report in 1813.
- **Contents (1002 pages):**
 - Pending petitions of zamindars, ryots, etc.
 - Statistical reports on revenue.
 - Reports of Collectors.
 - Notes on Judicial administration.
 - Figures were heavily exaggerated.
- **Impacts:**
 - Heavy debate in England over the maladministration of the East India Company (EIC).
 - End of EIC's monopoly in India in 1813.

Who were Paharias?

- **Basic Features:**
 - Lived in the Rajmahal hills.
- **Livelihood:** Hunting, shifting cultivation, charcoal production, silk worm rearing.
- Symbolized by the hoe.
- Led by a chief.
- **Paharias & Plains:** Regularly raided plains for resources and to assert authority; received extortion from traders and tributes from zamindars.
- **Paharias vs British:**
 - British wanted settled agriculture; Paharias refused as they were nomads.
 - **Policy of extermination:** 1770s.
 - **Policy of Pacification:** 1780s.
 - **Conclusion:** Receded deep into the mountains.

Who were Santhals?

- **Basic Features:**
 - Came to Bengal in the 1780s, very hardworking.
 - Initially worked for Zamindars, later used by British for settled agriculture in Rajmahal hills.
- **Santhals vs Paharias:**
 - Santhals were given land in the foothills of Rajmahal, called Damin-i-Koh, in 1832.
 - They started expelling Paharias to extend settled agriculture.
 - This tussle was known as the "battle between hoe and plough."
- **The Santhal Rebellion:**
 - **Background:** Exploitation of Santhals, increase in tax rate, heavy interest on debt, annexation of their lands by zamindars.
 - **The Rebellion:** Began on June 30, 1855. 10,000 Santhals fought, led by Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu.
 - **Conclusion:** Ended in 1856, Santhal Pargana was created.

The Accounts of Buchanan

- **Who was Buchanan?**
 - Surgeon to Governor-General Wellesley.
 - Geographer, historian, surveyor.
 - Helped EIC with his researches and experience.

- **What he wrote about?** Agriculture, mining, geography, revenue.
- **Are they reliable?** Not entirely, as his observations were inspired by colonial interests as an EIC employee.

Rebel and the Raj

The Revolt of 1857

- **Pattern of Rebellion:**
 - Started as a mutiny on May 10th.
 - White people and Britons were attacked.
 - Government buildings were destroyed, telegraph lines cut.
- **Leaders:**
 - Delhi: Bahadur Shah Zafar
 - Kanpur: Nana Saheb
 - Jhansi: Rani Laxmi Bai
 - Awadh: Begum Hazrat Mahal
 - Arrah: Kunwar Singh
- **Lines of Communication:** Espionage (spies), Panchayats held, decisions taken collectively.
- **Rumors & Prophecies:**
 - Bullets coated with fat of cows and pigs.
 - Bone dust of cows and pigs in flour.
 - Prophecy of end of British rule by June 23, 1857.

Reasons for the Revolt

- **Economic Cause:** Drain of wealth, destruction of handicraft industries, high land revenue.
- **Social Cause:** Discrimination, reforms, spread of Western education.
- **Religious Cause:** Propagation of Christianity, forced conversions.
- **Military Cause:** Unrest in Sepoys, greased cartridges, huge number of Sepoys in British Army.

Revolt in Awadh

- **Subsidiary Alliance:**
 - Imposed on Awadh in 1801.
- **Terms:** Protection from external & internal threats, British troop presence in state, no foreign relations without British consent.
- **Annexation of Awadh:**
 - Annexed in 1856 on basis of "misgovernance."
 - Nawab exiled.
 - Dissolution of court & culture, unemployment for artists, officials, poets, dancers, musicians, cooks, etc.
- **Taluqdars & Peasants:**
 - Summary settlement introduced in 1856.
 - Taluqdars lost lands and troops.
 - High revenue demand for peasants.
 - Both participated in the revolt in huge numbers.

Vision of Rebels

- **Call for Unity:** Appealed for Hindu-Muslim unity; proclamations attracted various groups. Mughal rule glorified for unity.
- **Symbol of Oppression:** Moneylenders attacked, account books burnt, shops looted.
- **Alternative Power:** Established authority in Delhi, Kanpur & Lucknow; appointments made for administration.

Repression of Revolt

- **Legal Action:** Martial Law paused; military officers & Britons empowered to punish suspects.
- **Military Action:** Reinforcements brought; attack from two sides to capture Delhi (one battalion from Lahore, one from Bengal).
- **Diplomatic Action:** Lured landlords to break unity; rewarded loyal landlords and dispossessed disloyal ones.

Portrayal of Revolt

- **British's View:**
 - **Attack on Women:** Rebels portrayed as attackers of women; paintings of feared British women and children popularized (e.g., "In Memoriam").
 - **Celebrating the Saviors:** British army officers celebrated (e.g., "Relief of Lucknow" painting).
 - **Vengeance and Retribution:** Visuals of executions circulated (e.g., execution of mutineers in Peshawar).
- **Nationalist View:**
 - Revolt celebrated as the first war of Independence.
 - Leaders represented as heroic figures; later movies made.
 - Took Revolt of 1857 as an inspiration.

Mahatma Gandhi & The Nationalist Movement

Making of Gandhi

- **Gandhi in South Africa:**
 - Fought against the Asiatic Registration Act.
 - First implementation of Satyagraha.
 - Promoted religious harmony.
 - Alerted upper caste to end discrimination.
- **Return to India:**
 - Returned in 1915.
 - Attended inauguration of BHU in 1916.
 - Appealed to Congress leadership to include poor & depressed classes in nationalism.

India between 1890-1915

- **Partition of Bengal:** Divided into East & West in 1905 to break religious harmony.
- **Swadeshi Movement:**
 - Launched against partition of Bengal in 1906.
 - Foreign goods destroyed.
 - Led to rise of Extremists in Congress.
- **Surat Split:** Congress divided into two sections: Moderates & Extremists.
- **Expansion of Congress:** Became a Pan-India Party, much expanded by 1915 compared to 1893.

Regional Satyagraha

- **Champaran (1917):**
 - **Reason:** To abolish the Tinkathia system.
 - **Conclusion:** Champaran Agrarian Law passed, abolishing the system.
- **Khedra (1918):**
 - **Reason:** Remission in taxation for farmers.
 - **Conclusion:** Remission given to those who could not pay; capable farmers still paid revenue.
- **Ahmedabad (1918):**
 - **Reason:** Better working conditions for mill workers and hike in wages.
 - **Conclusion:** 35% hike in wages.

Rowlatt Satyagraha

- **Reason:** Rowlatt Act (censorship of press, detention without trial).
- **Course of Events:**
 - Whole North India became active, most intense in Punjab.
 - Leaders of Congress arrested or detained.
- **Conclusion:** Ended with Jallianwala Bagh massacre; nationwide fame for Gandhi.

Non-Cooperation Movement

- **Causes:** Rowlatt Act, Jallianwala Bagh massacre.
- **Course of Events:**
 - Burnt foreign garments, students boycotted schools, lawyers boycotted courts.
 - Mill workers on strike, farmers in Awadh didn't pay taxes, forest law violated in Andhra.
- **Conclusion:** British Raj shaken, administration came to a standstill. Ended with Chauri-Chaura incident.

A People's Leader

- **Rumours:** About his miraculous power spread widely, popularizing him.
- **Social Reforms:** End of untouchability, promotion of self-reliance, child marriage, promotion of religious harmony.
- **Physical Appearance:** Appeared like a Fakir, which resonated with poor masses.

Salt Satyagraha

- **Causes:** Failure of Simon Commission, unfair taxation on salt, demand for Purna Swaraj.
- **Events:**
 - Dandi March began on March 13, 1930.
 - Broke salt law on April 6, 1930.
 - Gandhi and others arrested.
- **Significance:** Global attention, massive participation of women. British realized their rule would not last forever.

Dialogues and Negotiations

- **Gandhi-Irwin Pact (1931):** Civil Disobedience Movement revoked, prisoners released.
- **Second Round Table Conference:** No tangible conclusion. Congress wanted to represent whole India, but League, Ambedkar, and Princely states opposed this.
- **Cripps Mission (1942):**
 - **Purpose:** To negotiate Congress support in WWII.
 - **Status:** Failed.
- **Election of 1937:** Government of Congress in 8 out of 11 provinces. Muslim League performed poorly even in reserved seats for Muslims.

Climax: Independence and Partition

- **Quit India Movement (Aug 1942):** Mass movement led by young revolutionaries. Muslim League used this time to expand their base in Punjab and Sind.
- **Election of 1946:** Massive victory of Congress over General Seats; spectacular performance by League on Reserved Seats.
- **Cabinet Mission Plan:**
 - **Proposal:** United India with provincial groupings.
 - **Failed:** Due to disagreement.
- **Independence & Partition:**
 - Direct Action Day launched by Jinnah on August 16, 1947, to demand "Pakistan."
 - India became independent but divided into two nations.
 - Heavy riots all around. Gandhiji was consoling riot victims in Delhi, Punjab, and Bengal.

Knowing Gandhi

- **Public Speech:** Public voice of individuals. **Limitations:** Narrator can deliberately hide negative facts.
- **Letters:** Get to know personal emotions. **Limitations:** Letters of top leaders might be written with caution.
- **Autobiography:** Based on the author's point of view.
- **Newspaper:** English and Regional. Can show both Colonial and Nationalist views.
- **Government Records:** Written by policeman officials, often biased information.

Framing the Constitution

Challenges ahead of Constituent Assembly

- **Internal Challenges:**
 - Bring communal harmony, safeguard minorities.
 - Manage Princely States, uplift depressed classes.
 - Institute democracy, make the Constitution.
- **External Challenges:** Border security, face the Bi-Polar world (USA vs USSR).

The Constituent Assembly

- **Establishment:**
 - Established under the Cabinet Mission Plan of 1946.
 - Officially formed in November 1946.
 - First session held on December 9, 1946.
- **Composition:**
 - Before Partition: 389 members.
 - After Partition: 299 members (229 elected from provinces, 70 nominated by princely states).
 - Members were indirectly elected.
- **Diversity:**
 - Congress Party had around 82% members.
 - Despite majority, Congress members had diverse ideologies (Socialist, atheist, Hindu Nationalist, supporters of landlordism, etc.).
- **Influence of Public:**
 - Public allowed to submit opinions to the assembly.
- **Notable Demands:** Ban on Cow Slaughter, Constitution based on ancient Hindu books, Reservation for lower caste, Linguistic division of provinces, Safeguard to Vernaculars.

Dominant Voices in the Constituent Assembly

- **Jawahar Lal Nehru:** First Prime Minister of India. Proposed the Objective Resolution (Dec 13, 1946).
- **Dr. Rajendra Prasad:** President of Constituent Assembly. Moderated discussions.
- **Sardar Patel:** First Home Minister of India. Played a great role in amalgamation of princely states.
- **B. R. Ambedkar:** First Law Minister of India. Chairman of Drafting Committee.
- **K. M. Munshi:** Member of Drafting Committee. Participated in many discussions.
- **A. K. Ayyar:** Member of Drafting Committee. Participated in many discussions (Minority, proclamation of emergency, Fundamental rights).
- **B. N. Rau:** Constitutional Advisor. Prepared the outline of Indian Constitution.
- **S. N. Mukherjee:** Chief Draughtsman. Expert in drafting intricate proposals into simple legal format.

The Objective Resolution

- **Introduction:**
 - Proposed on December 13, 1946.
 - Laid the ideals and basic principles of the Constitution.
 - Preamble based on the Objective Resolution.
 - Adopted by assembly on January 22, 1947.
- **Key Features:**
 - India is an Independent, Sovereign, and Republic.
 - Social, Political, and economic justice for all.
 - Adequate safeguard to minorities and depressed classes.
 - Power should come from the people.

Earlier Constitutional Developments

- **Act of 1909 (Morley-Minto Reforms):**
 - Introduction of Separate Electorates.
 - Political representation given to Indians for the first time.
 - Indians could be elected indirectly in legislative assemblies.
- **Act of 1919 (Montague-Chelmsford Reforms):**
 - Seats increased in Legislative Assemblies.
 - Extension of separate electorates to Sikhs, Anglo-Indians, Indian Christians, and Europeans.
- **Act of 1935:** Allowed direct elections for the first time in Provincial Legislatures.

Discussion on Separate Electorates

- **Arguments in Favour:**
 - On August 27, 1947, B. Pocker Bahadur demanded separate electorates for Muslims.
 - Argued only separate electorates could ensure safeguard of Muslims and non-Muslims could not represent Muslims.
- **Arguments Against:**
 - R. V. Dhulekar and Sardar Patel argued separate electorates were main reason behind Partition.
 - Govind Ballabh Pant argued this could be suicidal for minorities and the State.
- **Conclusion:** On intervention of Begum Aizaz Rasul, League members gave up demand for separate electorates.

Discussion on Rights of Minorities

- **Ranga's Arguments:** N. G. Ranga (socialist) said poor and downtrodden were real minorities; legal rights alone not enough, conditions needed for exercising rights.
- **Arguments of Tribal:** Jaipal Singh Munda represented tribes; argued tribals were not numerical minorities but suppressed for thousands of years. Demanded others mix with tribes and not isolate them.
- **Arguments of Dalits:** J. Nagappa argued suffering from social marginalization. Many leaders, including Dakshayani Velayudhan, demanded moral and legal safeguards.
- **Voice of Women:** Hansa Mehta from Bombay demanded Economic, Political, and Social Justice, and equality.

Discussion on Division of Power

- **What was Decided?**
 - Three lists of subjects: Union List, State List, Concurrent List.
 - Excessive powers transferred to Union and Concurrent lists.
- **Arguments for Strong Centre:**
 - B. R. Ambedkar, Gopalaswami Ayyanagar, and top Congress leaders favored a strong centre.
 - Balakrishna Sharma said only a strong centre could plan for everyone's well-being and resist foreign aggression.
- **Why Strong Centre?**
 - To restore communal harmony.
 - To defend the country.
 - Economic planning.
- **Arguments against Strong Centre:** K. Santhanam pointed out center overburdening itself; demanded sufficient revenue sources for state list.

Discussion on National Language

- **Gandhi's Thought:** Desired Hindustani as National language, believing it promoted religious harmony as a blend of Hindi and Urdu.
- **Plea For Hindi:** R. V. Dhulekar was most vocal among supporters of Hindi.
- **Arguments against Hindi:**
 - Shrimati G. Durgabai argued imposing Hindustani would be harmful as it lost its composite culture.
 - Other leaders feared Hindi might destroy their regional languages.
- **Conclusion:**
 - Hindi made official language.
 - No National Language in India.
 - States allowed to add one regional language as their official language.

Salient Features of Indian Constitution

- The Indian Constitution is the largest Constitution in the world.
- Took 2 Years, 11 Months, and 18 Days to finish.
- Total money spent was worth 64 Lakhs.
- **Six Fundamental Rights:**
 1. Right to Equality (Article 14-18)
 2. Right to Freedom (Article 19-22)
 3. Right against Exploitation (Article 23-24)
 4. Right to Freedom of Religion (Article 25-28)
 5. Cultural and Educational Rights (Article 29-30)
 6. Right to Constitutional Remedies (Article 32)
- The Indian constitution embodies the positive concept of secularism, giving equal respect to all religions or protecting all religions equally.



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